See the People ... Video Discussion Guide

You don’t have to camp out to participate! Host or join a discussion, show a video, invite a speaker, help with basic-needs giving, or share the event. Overnight camping is optional.

Recommended, not required: These video selections are prompts for open discussion, not a test of agreement. Read why we’re here.

Recommended Resources ... Not Required

Our educational materials reflect a "shelter first" and lowest-barrier approach to addressing homelessness. They are recommended resources, not required material. If your group chooses not to use them, your participation is still encouraged.

Awareness doesn’t take sides ... all voices and perspectives are encouraged. However, Campout for Compassion will not provide or recommend "treatment first" materials.

Campout for Compassion 2026 Saturday, November 14

One Night. Many Locations. One Community. Rather than gathering at one central campsite, we’re bringing our community together across many locations for one shared night of awareness, understanding, and compassion.

Start with firsthand experiences. Listen to people who have experienced homelessness, then explore the assumptions, evidence, and local questions their stories raise. These videos are optional and do not replace an invited local voice. Our myths, facts, and realities guide helps groups follow up.

Choosing videos by age

Ages 6 ... 10: The drawing, home-safety, and kindness activities in the activity guide are a better starting point. No video is automatically recommended for young children.

Ages 11 ... 13: An adult-previewed, non-graphic excerpt of "Can You Tell Who is HOMELESS?" may be suitable. Use simple, respectful questions.

Ages 14 ... 17: Consider language, teen and family housing topics, or a pre-screened firsthand story. Offer a non-video option.

Adults: Begin with firsthand interviews and discuss assumptions, housing affordability, dignity, and local questions. Provider-oriented videos are optional deeper learning.

Please preview before showing: We verified the publisher pages and titles, but have not viewed every video in full or verified age ratings, run times, caption availability, or all potentially upsetting scenes. The short descriptions below identify discussion themes rather than summarizing a verified complete transcript. Facilitators must screen the videos first. Never require a participant to disclose their own experience. Some people in the room may have experienced housing insecurity.

Easy discussion format

Before (5 minutes): Ask what people already think and agree on respectful language. Watch (5 ... 15 minutes): Show one vetted firsthand interview or excerpt. Explore (10 minutes): What assumptions does it challenge? Which claims can we verify? Discuss (10 ... 15 minutes): What would you want to learn from someone in Chico?

Start here ... firsthand stories

These Invisible People interviews invite us to see beyond stereotypes. The people speaking represent their own experiences, not everyone who has been unhoused. Hosts should preview every video and allow participants to opt out.

Arleen: A Mother's Fight for Stability in America's Hidden Homeless Crisis (https://invisiblepeople.tv/videos/hidden-homeless-mother-arleen-family-hotel-crisis/)

Why show it: A first-person account of a mother facing housing instability and uncertainty while caring for her family.

Invisible People Suggested group: Older teens and adults

Discuss: What becomes more difficult for children when housing is unstable?

Cheri - Homeless Senior Living in Hotel (https://invisiblepeople.tv/videos/cheri-homeless-senior-st-louis/)

Why show it: A senior's first-person account that opens conversation about income, shelter, and the cost of housing.

Invisible People Suggested group: Adults and service groups

Discuss: Why might benefits or employment still not cover housing costs?

Melissa: Why Homeless Couples Choose the Streets Over Shelter in Seattle (https://invisiblepeople.tv/videos/melissa-why-homeless-couples-choose-the-streets-over-shelter-in-seattle/)

Why show it: A first-person perspective on the complicated decision to use shelter when couples cannot remain together.

Invisible People Suggested group: Ages 16+ and adults

Discuss: What matters besides bed availability when considering shelter options?

Skid Row Homeless Sweeps Make Homelessness Worse (https://invisiblepeople.tv/videos/skid-row-homeless-sweeps-make-homelessness-worse/)

Why show it: A firsthand reporting perspective on displacement, sweeps, and what happens after a camp is cleared.

Invisible People Suggested group: Adults and ages 16+ with care

Discuss: What happens when people are moved but not housed?

Kim: From Freezing in a Tent to the Safety of a Home (https://invisiblepeople.tv/videos/kim-from-freezing-in-a-tent-to-the-safety-of-a-home/)

Why show it: A story of moving from a tent toward stable housing, useful for discussing what meaningful progress looks like.

Invisible People Suggested group: Older teens and adults

Discuss: What would lasting success look like for someone facing repeated displacement?

Then examine assumptions and language

These OrgCode selections invite discussion about labels and first impressions. Pair them with the myths and realities guide and independently verified sources.

Can You Tell Who is HOMELESS? (https://www.orgcode.com/youtube-videos/v/npm7wshpjrcjgdlp5apd5janx3jmrw)

Why show it: A conversation starter about the assumptions we make from clothing, appearance, and first impressions.

OrgCode Suggested group: Ages 11 ... 13+ with adult preview

Discuss: What assumptions do we make based on appearance?

Why PERSON-FIRST Language is Important. (https://www.orgcode.com/youtube-videos/v/wsahzesjchlhj8r373zjgm7ft5y5cy)

Why show it: Introduces the idea of describing someone as a person rather than reducing them to a housing status.

OrgCode Suggested group: Teens 14+ and adults

Discuss: How can language describe someone's situation without defining the person?

Additional context ... families, services, and community responses

Choose only what fits your audience; no one video is the event's required lesson.

Why So Many Teens Are Becoming Homeless (https://www.orgcode.com/youtube-videos/v/jxj9yyrw8cs6f7mcfpgrr3lw2xwpn2)

Why show it: Explores why young people may lose stable housing and what support they need to stay safe.

OrgCode Suggested group: Teens 14+ and youth leaders

Discuss: What support could help a young person keep a safe place to stay?

The Reality of Family Homelessness (https://www.orgcode.com/youtube-videos/v/ez2gag84azet7lfkw8t5csranjlz6s)

Why show it: Introduces the forms of family homelessness that can be less visible than sleeping outdoors.

OrgCode Suggested group: Older teens and adults

Discuss: Why can family homelessness be difficult to recognize?

Why So Many Seniors Are Becoming Homeless (https://www.orgcode.com/youtube-videos/v/h6c3tbmlalw47jfxshejesawwj95ra)

Why show it: Opens discussion about the pressures older adults face when rent and resources do not match.

OrgCode Suggested group: Adults and church groups

Discuss: What support helps older neighbors remain safely housed?

Why Homeless Services Fail Without Choice (https://www.orgcode.com/youtube-videos/v/pmsgl34l5cdll7t34mggws3yhnr9hl)

Why show it: Explores why services can fail when they do not account for people's actual circumstances and choices.

OrgCode Suggested group: Adults and service organizations

Discuss: What makes a service workable for one person but not another?

Housing: Human Right or Reward? (https://www.orgcode.com/youtube-videos/v/92pcbc959676emy394wy6t3cb6fxas)

Why show it: Raises the question of whether safe housing should depend on meeting conditions or be a foundation for stability.

OrgCode Suggested group: Adults and discussion groups

Discuss: What do people mean by compassion and accountability in housing?

Homeless ENCAMPMENT Response 101 (https://www.orgcode.com/youtube-videos/v/hc7gt6d6kkkdsk8kgecmhw2k643mt8)

Why show it: Introduces approaches and outcome measures for community responses to outdoor encampments.

OrgCode Suggested group: Adults and civic groups

Discuss: How should success be measured for an encampment response?

Don’t Want Homelessness Services in Your Backyard? Front yard it is. (https://www.orgcode.com/youtube-videos/v/jlaljxrcd5ht4zrw2smhle7p4pcw4g)

Why show it: Examines neighborhood objections and how community concerns may be discussed constructively.

OrgCode Suggested group: Adults and neighborhood groups

Discuss: How do we hear neighborhood concerns without dehumanizing anyone?

Optional provider-oriented learning ... shared values

Iain De Jong’s video is valuable for thinking about how organizations put values into practice, including autonomy and recovery. It is no longer the main public-awareness lesson.

The Missing Piece in Ending Homelessness: Shared Values (https://www.orgcode.com/youtube-videos/v/29rnf5pc36ammyk3amwljabjep2h9e)

Why show it: Opens discussion about shared community values among people who disagree about homelessness policy.

OrgCode Suggested group: Adults and mixed community groups

Discuss: What do we have in common even when we disagree about solutions?

For group leaders

Original footage and commentary belong to OrgCode and Invisible People. Play videos from the publisher’s original page; check copyright and public screening conditions before projecting to a large public audience. A linked resource should not be taken as an endorsement of all statements made in it.

You may also browse the OrgCode video library (https://www.orgcode.com/youtube-videos) and Invisible People video library (https://invisiblepeople.tv/videos/) for additional topics.

For questions or suggestions, email scotty@sfranzyshen.org.

Host guide Age-appropriate activities Campout home